

Figure 4.13 *Chisht, mausoleums (or* madrasa*/mosque complex), ruins: Mausoleum A, interior, corner pillars and two adjoining walls with inset arches, with bands of inscriptions following outline of upper arches and running horizontally across midpoint of arches. © Photograph Josephine Powell c. 1960. Harvard Fine Arts Library, Special Collections.*

Like Shah-i Mashhad, the Chisht structures are also oriented along a north–south axis with a slight deviation, but here clockwise, with the buildings' western walls again facing just perceptibly off true west (Figure 4.16).[74] While the nature of the original complex is difficult to discern with certainty, parts of the epigraphic program and other features of both domed structures provide clues as to what was likely a site with multiple functions. Tellingly, the more deteriorated northeastern building (Figure 4.12 [right structure], Figure 4.16) still preserves a *mihrab* on its western wall (Figure 4.17); in its original state the *mihrab* was probably plastered and covered with lavish molded stucco decoration, remnants of which are still *in situ* above the arch. The large pointed-arch motifs diagonally above and on either side of the *mihrab* not only echo the latter's form, but the curves of the arches contain bands framing the above-discussed foliated Kufic inscription with Ghiyath al-Din's titles. Smaller medallions